Tarpley's remark, once, that a good chemist had to have a detective instinct). It dealt with the manner in which chemists had worked out the chemical structure of the molecule of biotin, one of the B vitamins.

I finished it on April 3 and sent it to Campbell, for Astounding regularly published a nonfiction piece or two every issue. My thio-timoline article had been published under that heading, for instance. Campbell returned "Detective Story for Non-chemists" at once, however. It was far too straight, far too detailed, far too dull. I did not, however, forget it, or my general desire to write nonfiction.

On April 6, I began the revision of "Grow Old with Me." I note that in my diary of that day I had finally learned the correct quotation and called it "Grow Old Along with Me." That was the title I used thereafter and it cheered me to do so. I think I felt a sneaking suspicion that changing the title would break the jinx.

I worked on the story every day, and the revision and lengthening went rapidly.

And on April 14, the short version of my dissertation was completed and I was ready to send it off to the Journal of the American Chemical Society, which was the Astounding of the chemical journals.

Boston

On April 20, I went to Boston to look into the matter of housing—obviously the first hurdle to get over. Again I stayed at the Boyds' and that evening I met Fred Whipple, a Harvard astronomer, and his wife, Babbie. Fred was tall, slim, good-humored, and forty-two years old; Babbie was short, smiling, and pretty.

That evening, Bill broke the rather shocking news to me that he was planning to go to Cairo, Egypt, to take a civil-service position as a P7. It caught me by surprise and my spirits fell sharply. Bill was the only person in Boston I could count as a friend. With him gone I would be a stranger in a strange land. I might not have accepted the job if I had not had the comfortable feeling of at least one known quantity I could cling to.

Bill, perhaps sensing my distress, offered to take me along as a P6, but I wouldn't return to civil service even in New York, let alone in Cairo, so I refused. I returned by train on the night of April 21-22, stayed awake all night, and came home in complete panic. I didn't want to leave New York. I